

Quest for Answers

Priyanka Vadera's meeting with Nalini Sriharan—one of the conspirators in her father Rajiv Gandhi's assassination—to make peace with herself, comes in an age in which hatred and bloodshed has become the order of the day ("Forgive but not Forget", April 28). Her sentiments must be respected.

BIDYUT KUMAR CHATTERJEE,
Faridabad

One wonders what reply Priyanka would give if the family members of the 1,500-odd Indian Army personnel who died in Sri Lanka asked, "Why did your good father send my father/son/husband to fight some one else's battle who was left to die in an alien land?" But these families, sadly, do not have a voice.

DILIP JOSHI, Pune

Blood-less Coup

The resounding victory of the Marxists in Nepal polls disproves the puerile Marxist theory that the proletariat can achieve power only through a violent revolution ("A Seismic Shift", April 28). Yet another Marxist theory goes awry.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, Kolkata

Cricket in the Fast Lane

The newly inaugurated IPL T20 championship is supposed to be all about innovation, but the teams have been named very unimaginatively ("Fasten Your Seatbelts", April 28). We have a drum roll of tired, simplistic names that do not do justice to the format.

SHEKAR SARMA, Bangalore

IPL proves that Indians purr the loudest.

RAJNEESH BATRA, Delhi

The new game of T20, Has thrills galore aplenty. The batsmen make strokes meaty, They get bowlers sweaty. Obsolete becomes the ball red, The staid game will soon be dead.

SHANMUGAM MUDALIAR, Pune

The presence of half-nude girls and Bollywood stars

has made a tamasha (mockery) of a serious game of cricket. One wonders whether Indian cricket is moving in the right direction or not.

MAHESH KUMAR, Delhi

Correction

The country celebrated the 117th birth anniversary of Dr B.R. Ambedkar and not his 177th birthday as has been mentioned erroneously in the epilogue of the Vis-à-Vis (April 28). The error is regretted.

STANDING TALL

There could not have been a better issue than this one on great Indians ("60 Greatest Indians", April 21). The articles were superb and were backed by excellent pictures. Like many previous issues of the magazine, this one too will be a part of my INDIA TODAY collection.

S. BALAKRISHNAN,

Jamshedpur



We've had enough of great Indians. It's time you took out an issue on "One Hundred Worst Indians". There is no doubt that a large number of politicians will figure in the list along side criminals, gangsters and swindlers.

RAVI BEDI, Jodhpur

The special issue drives home the point that there is no need to look at the Western world for lessons in leadership and social change. These remarkable personalities will continue to inspire generations to come and they should be emulated by present and future generations.

SUNIL KUMAR, Delhi

Most articles featured in INDIA TODAY were shallow and no pains were taken to research these personalities properly.

REVI SHETTY, Mangalore

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

30

Years Ago in India Today

MAY 16-31, 1978



Beginning of the End?

Three days before the polling day, a few miles out of Azamgarh town, Janata minister Atal Behari Vajpayee was delivering a campaign address that has become typical of his politics—persuasive without losing ground, yet quick-witted without dishing out populist slogans. Having dwelled on the Janata's policies, he arrived at a subject of common interest: Indira Gandhi. His



tone changed, Mrs Gandhi and together with it the mood of the audience. "This is no ordinary election, my friends," he said. "Had it just been another parliamentary poll, do you think she would have bothered to come and stay with you for five days?" Even at that late stage in the campaign, Vajpayee was perhaps one of the few to grasp the point. Even as he voiced it, Indira Gandhi was but a few hours away, speeding through Uttar Pradesh on her barnstorming tours that eventually won her the Azamgarh seat.

—Sunil Sethi

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (toll free) BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday–Friday, 10am–6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com